

# Write a finding statement

Activity · Results Communication · ~15 min

## BEFORE YOU START

- You have a recent FASTR analysis output (chart, table, or interpretation note) in front of you
- You've identified at least one **interesting finding** from it — a change, a pattern, an outlier

## WHY THIS MATTERS

Raw findings are easy to *see* but hard to *communicate*. A good finding statement does three things in one or two sentences:

1. Names the **indicator**, **direction**, and **magnitude** of the change
2. Anchors it in **place and period** so the reader knows where and when
3. Adds a brief **interpretation** so the reader knows what it might mean

Without these, a finding lands as "interesting data" — not as something a decision-maker can act on.

## The formula

**[Indicator] [trend] from [value] to [value] in [place/period]. This suggests [interpretation].**

Pick one finding from your FASTR analysis and write it out using the formula. Then read it back — would someone unfamiliar with your data understand what happened and why it matters?

Write your finding here:

Indicator: \_\_\_\_\_

Trend: \_\_\_\_\_

From: \_\_\_\_\_ To: \_\_\_\_\_

Place / period: \_\_\_\_\_

This suggests: \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

## Worked examples

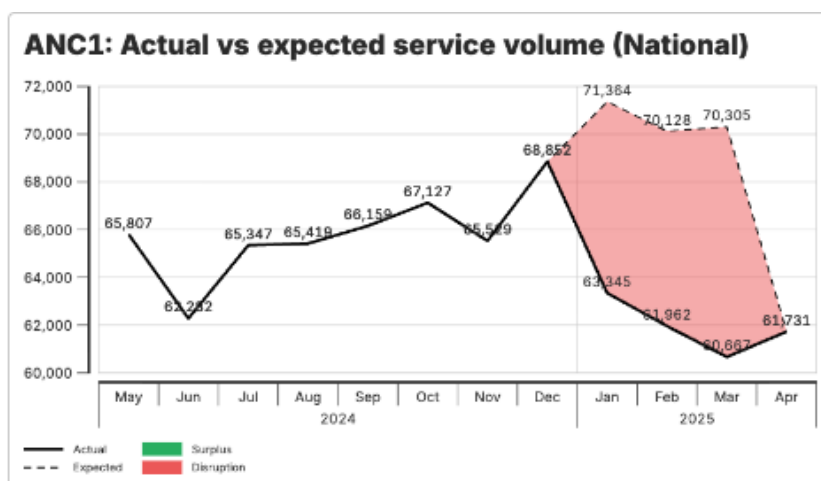
### Weak (result only):

ANC1 was 12,400 in Q1 2026.

### Better (uses the formula):

ANC1 visits **dropped 18%** in the Northern Region, **from 14,200 in Q1 2025 to 11,640 in Q1 2026**. This suggests **service disruption** rather than a data quality issue — completeness was stable and the drop is consistent across all districts in the region.

Notice what the better version adds:



- A **direction and magnitude** (dropped 18%)
- A **time comparison** (Q1 2025 → Q1 2026)
- A **place** (Northern Region)
- An **interpretation** that rules out alternatives (data quality)

## Pitfalls

**"This suggests" is the hardest part.** It's tempting to skip — but a finding without interpretation forces the reader to do the work. Take a stand.

- Avoid "interesting" or "concerning" as your interpretation — they're empty. Say *what* is concerning and *why*.
- If you really don't know what it means, say so explicitly: *"This pattern needs further investigation — we are unable to rule out [X] without [Y]."* That's still a defensible position.

## Peer check

Swap your finding statement with a colleague. Ask them:

- Can you tell what happened, where, when, and by how much?
- Is the interpretation specific enough to be useful?
- Is there anything you'd want to know that's missing?

## What's next

Once your findings are sharp, the next activity is **Link your results to actions** — taking each finding and pairing it with a decision-maker and a concrete next step.